



Maritime &
Coastguard
Agency

Guidance

Annex A: Military Explosives - Ministry of Defence Requirements

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1. Introduction

1.1 “Military explosives” means any Class 1 goods:

- a) under the control of the Secretary of State for Defence;
- b) held for the service of the Crown for the purposes of the Ministry of Defence (MoD)
- c) under the control of one of the armed forces; or
- d) the carriage of which is certified by the Secretary of State for Defence to be in connection with the execution of a contract with the Secretary of State for Defence or with one of the armed forces

1.2 The movement of military explosives is subject to the conditions set out hereunder, in addition to the requirements of the International Maritime Dangerous Goods (IMDG) Code.

2. Mixed Loading of Military and Commercial Explosives of Class 1

2.1 Except in the case of loading or unloading roll-on, roll-off (ro-ro) traffic where lifting or handling of the explosives does not occur, military and commercial explosives should not be present at the same time at a berth or bay alongside a vessel during loading and unloading operations.

2.2 Military and commercial explosives should not be loaded or unloaded simultaneously into or from the same vessel.

3. Government Authorised Explosives Representative

3.1 A Government Authorised Explosives Representative (GAER) should be in attendance during the loading, handling, and discharge of military explosives at any harbour area ^[footnote 1] within the UK in ports which are authorised to handle explosives, except as shown in 3.3, 3.5 and 3.6 below.

3.2 Table 1 identifies the nature and maximum quantity of ammunition and explosives that may be present within the harbour area, without the expectation for the physical attendance of the GAER. When this is applied within the UK the harbour authority will manage the explosives safety requirements and the consignor will be available to provide support to the harbour authority and vessel operator, if required.

3.3 Table 1, maximum quantity of military explosives before a GAER is required:

Loose Packages and Pallets

Nature	NEM(Net Explosives Mass)	Remarks
Hazard Division (HD) 1.4	Unlimited	All Compatibility Groups (CG)
Articles for lifesaving	50 kg or less	HD 1.1, 1.2, and 1.3
Articles of CG, B, C, D, E, G or N	50 kg or less	HD 1.1, 1.2 and 1.3

Closed Cargo Transport Unit (CTU) for Class 1

Nature	NEM(Net Explosives Mass)	Remarks
HD 1.4	Unlimited	All CGs
HD 1.1, 1.2 and 1.3	250 kg or less	All CGs

3.4 Table 2 identifies the nature and quantity of ammunition and explosives carried on a road transport unit that may be driven on and off a ro-ro vessel by the vehicle driver, without the expectation for the physical attendance of a GAER. When this is applied within the UK, the harbour authority will arrange the military explosives safety requirements and the consignor will be available to provide support to the harbour authority and vessel operator, if required.

3.5 Table 2, GAER exception for accompanied road transport units on ro-ro vessels:

Accompanied Road Transport Unit on Ro-Ro Vessel

Nature	NEM(Net Explosives Mass)	Remarks
UN Class 1	Unlimited	All CGs except A and L

3.6 There is no expectation for a GAER to be present during the loading or unloading of military explosives that are part of the weapon systems or safety systems of a ship under the control of the Armed Forces.

3.7 Dangerous Goods in Harbour Areas Regulations 2016^[footnote 2] (DGHAR) disallows any dangerous goods on a vessel that are part of the equipment or stores of that vessel or is for safety purposes of the vessel. The MoD will require qualified and competent personnel both on the vessel and shoreside to supervise the loading and unloading of explosives for warships to ensure this is completed safely.

3.8 The outline duties of the GAER are detailed in Appendix 1 to this Annex. The duties essentially are to render advice to the master of the vessel or the harbour authority regarding the handling and stowage of military explosives and to bring to their notice any breaches of regulations or good safety practices.

Appendix 1 to Annex A

Duties Of Government Authorised Explosives Representative

1. The Government Authorised Explosives Representative (GAER) is to ensure the movement of military explosives is carried out safely and in accordance with relevant and appropriate regulations. They are responsible for bringing immediately to the attention of the Harbour Master and/or the Service Authority concerned any unsafe practices or violations of the regulations they may observe or have brought to their attention.

2. **GAER specific requirements.** The GAER shall:

- a) liaise with the Harbour Master to pre-plan the move prior to commencement.

- b) check the stowage arrangements and ensure adequate segregation measures are in place.
- c) ensure they are available and/or contactable for the duration of the military explosives transiting the harbour.
- d) ensure that the firefighting arrangements at the harbour meet the statutory requirements.
- e) check that the harbour has adequate emergency plans in place.
- f) for loose packaged and palletted consignments:
 - i) ensure that packages and overpacks containing military explosives have hazard labels, marks and documentation in accordance with the requirements of the International Maritime Dangerous Goods (IMDG) Code.
 - ii) in the event of any packages being damaged or found with a broken seal, the GAER will advise the harbour master on appropriate action to take.
 - iii) when any explosives articles or substances (including ammunition) have been observed to; or have been reported to; have deteriorated or be in an unsafe state (e.g., a dropped fused article) then the harbour master is to be informed immediately. The GAER shall then advise the harbour master as to what further action is to be taken.
- g) for consignments contained in any Cargo Transport Unit (CTU):
 - i) ensure any CTU marking, placarding and documentation conforms to the requirements of the IMDG Code.
 - h) if any concerns are raised during the movement of military explosives, which require the attention of the Harbour Master and/or the Service Authority, these should be reported to the relevant regulatory body.

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1. The Dangerous Goods in Harbour Areas Regulations 2016
([legislation.gov.uk](https://www.legislation.gov.uk))
(<https://www.legislation.gov.uk/uksi/2016/721/contents/made>)
 2. The Dangerous Goods in Harbour Areas Regulations 2016
(<https://www.legislation.gov.uk/uksi/2016/721/contents/made>)



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